

The Politics and Evolution of the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) in the Fourth Republic: Issues and Controversies

¹Mojeed Oyetunji Oyedokun

&

²Shola Ahmed Akanbi

Abstract

The Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) has emerged as a central actor in Nigeria's Fourth Republic, operating both as a cooperative platform for intergovernmental relations and as a politically influential elite bloc. This study examines the Forum's evolution, institutional development, and controversies, situating it within the dynamics of Nigerian federalism. Drawing on historical documents and secondary literature, the paper explores how the NGF has shaped executive federalism, intergovernmental bargaining, and intra-party power relations. Established in 1999 as a consultative forum for peer learning among state executives, the NGF has grown into a powerful informal institution with significant influence over fiscal negotiations, national policymaking, and electoral politics. Yet, its informal status and lack of constitutional recognition have produced institutional ambiguities, exemplified by leadership disputes and factional crises, such as the 2013 chairmanship conflict. The study argues that the NGF reflects both the promise and perils of Nigeria's democratic consolidation: it strengthens intergovernmental collaboration and policy innovation while amplifying elite polarisation and weakening institutional accountability. Understanding the NGF's evolution provides insights into the role of informal institutions in hybrid democracies and the persistent tensions in Nigeria's federal system.

Keywords: Nigeria Governors' Forum, Fourth Republic, federalism, intergovernmental relations, democratic consolidation

Introduction

Nigeria's return to democratic rule in 1999 marked a pivotal shift in the country's governance and intergovernmental relations (Suberu, 2018; Ibeanu & Egwu, 2021). Among the key outcomes of this transition was the emergence of the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF), a voluntary association of state executives originally designed to foster consultation, policy coordination, and the exchange of best practices across states. Over the past two decades, the NGF has evolved into one of the most influential informal institutions in Nigeria's Fourth

1 **Corresponding author:** Department of History and International Studies, Edo State University, Iyamho, Edo State

Email: doubleoyeonline@gmail.com

2 Department of History and International Relations, Muhammad Kamalud-deen, University, Ilorin

Email: akanbiahmed66@gmail.com

Republic, shaping national policy debates, influencing party politics, and, at times, challenging the authority of the federal government (Omotola, 2014; Iledare, 2019).

The evolution of the NGF illustrates the complex dynamics of Nigeria's federal system, where inter-state cooperation exists alongside intense political competition. The Forum has actively engaged in debates over revenue allocation, fiscal federalism, and national security, reinforcing its relevance in policymaking. At the same time, internal conflicts, such as the 2013 leadership crisis that split the Forum into factions led by Rotimi Amaechi and Jonah Jang, reveal the tension between collaborative objectives and partisan interests, raising questions about the NGF's cohesion and institutional independence (Ojo, 2022; NGF Secretariat, 2023). Beyond policy coordination, the NGF increasingly functions as a collective political platform through which governors pursue national-level interests. While initiatives in healthcare, education, and public financial management have advanced governance in some states, the Forum's involvement in electoral disputes and constitutional debates has attracted criticism regarding its neutrality and legitimacy (NGF, 2020; Ojo, 2022).

The persistent structural and institutional challenges in Nigeria's democracy have further constrained the consolidation of a robust democratic system. At independence in 1960, Nigeria was broadly on par with several peer nations; yet, over the decades, these countries have advanced, while Nigeria continues to lag. Despite numerous reform initiatives, entrenched political, economic, and institutional weaknesses have limited progress, and comprehensive solutions to address these developmental deficits remain elusive. This enduring pattern of stagnation raises critical questions about the ways in which governance structures, federal institutions, and elite coordination either facilitate or impede national development.

To explore these dynamics, this paper examines the politics and evolution of the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) in the Fourth Republic, situating its activities and influence within broader debates on democratic consolidation, governance, and federalism. Using a historical qualitative approach and O'Donnell's delegative democracy framework, the study assesses how the NGF both strengthens intergovernmental collaboration and mediates elite competition, offering new insights into the functioning of informal institutions within hybrid democratic contexts. The paper is structured as follows: Introduction, The Emergence and Evolution of the Nigeria Governors' Forum, Methodology, The NGF, Democratic Consolidation, and Governance Outcomes, Institutional Significance of the NGF in Democratic Dispensation, Policy Implications, and Conclusion.

The Emergence and Evolution of the Nigeria Governors' Forum

The Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) emerged in 1999 following Nigeria's transition to democratic rule, reflecting the growing need for structured engagement among state executives within the federal system (NGF Secretariat, 2021; Suberu, 2018). Although lacking formal constitutional recognition, the Forum was established as a voluntary association to foster collaboration among governors and provide a collective platform for engaging the federal government on shared developmental and administrative concerns. Its formation aimed to articulate common state interests and improve coordination across the federation, positioning the NGF as both a consultative and politically strategic institution.

During its formative years (1999–2006), under Governors Abdullahi Adamu and Victor Attah, the NGF maintained a largely technocratic character, focusing on fiscal coordination, capacity building, and the exchange of policy experiences (Adegboye, 2017). Collaboration with international development partners such as the World Bank, DFID, and UNDP supported

reforms in public sector management and fiscal responsibility at the subnational level, consolidating the Forum's reputation as a cooperative and advisory body.

By the late 2000s, under Governor Bukola Saraki (2007–2011), the NGF began to take on a more overtly political role, adopting unified positions on national policy issues such as revenue allocation, fuel subsidy management, and proposed constitutional amendments (Suberu, 2018; Ojo, 2022). This period reflects the Forum's transition from a primarily consultative body to a platform through which governors collectively influenced federal policymaking, illustrating the interplay between institutional design and elite agency.

The NGF's political prominence intensified between 2011 and 2015, a period marked by internal contestation and partisanship. The 2013 chairmanship crisis, involving Governors Rotimi Amaechi and Jonah Jang, resulted in factionalisation that disrupted the Forum's operations and exposed deep political divisions among governors (Omotola, 2014; Edeh, 2025). This episode demonstrates how informal institutions within a hybrid democratic context can be simultaneously cooperative and vulnerable to elite competition, reflecting key aspects of delegative democracy theory (O'Donnell, 1994).

Following this crisis, successive leaders, including Governors Abdulaziz Yari (2015–2019) and Kayode Fayemi (2019–2023), worked to restore unity and refocus the NGF on policy coordination and technical engagement with federal institutions (NGF Secretariat, 2023). Initiatives in fiscal transparency, healthcare, and education exemplify the Forum's continuing commitment to cooperative federalism, even as political considerations shape its agenda. Since 2023, under Governor AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq, the NGF has emphasised intergovernmental dialogue and collective policy action, particularly in response to challenges such as economic recovery and security concerns.

Overall, the course of the NGF illustrates the tension between state autonomy and collective action in Nigeria's federal system. Its evolution highlights how informal institutions mediate elite interaction, influence policy, and respond to structural incentives within hybrid democratic contexts. By tracing this history, the study demonstrates how the NGF simultaneously embodies cooperation, political contestation, and institutional innovation, offering insights into the functioning of informal political institutions in Africa.

Methodology

This article adopts a historical research approach to examine the emergence, evolution, and contemporary role of the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) within Nigeria's Fourth Republic. The study traces institutional developments from 1999 to 2025, with the aim of situating the Forum's actions within the broader context of Nigeria's federal practice and political economy.

The research draws on qualitative historical sources. Primary materials include official communiqués, reports, and policy documents issued by the NGF Secretariat; federal government policy statements; records of intergovernmental engagements; and public speeches and interviews by state governors and federal officials. These sources provide direct insight into the Forum's stated objectives, internal dynamics, and responses to key political and economic developments.

These materials are supplemented by contemporaneous newspaper coverage from major Nigerian media outlets. Media reports are used to reconstruct critical events such as leadership contests, internal disputes, collective policy positions, and periods of institutional inactivity.

Rather than being treated as neutral accounts, these sources are read critically as part of the historical record, reflecting elite positioning, political contestation, and public discourse at specific moments.

Secondary sources, including peer-reviewed journal articles, books, and policy reports on Nigerian federalism, intergovernmental relations, and subnational governance, are used to contextualise the primary evidence and situate the NGF within existing empirical literature. These works inform the interpretation of events without imposing a formal theoretical framework on the analysis.

The study proceeds through chronological reconstruction, identifying key phases in the NGF's development and focusing on critical episodes that reveal shifts in its institutional role and political behaviour. Particular attention is paid to moments of crisis and reform, including leadership disputes and major federal economic decisions, as these episodes illuminate changes in the Forum's capacity for collective action and policy advocacy. To enhance reliability, evidence is triangulated across official documents, media reports, and scholarly accounts. This approach helps to mitigate the limitations of elite-produced sources and supports a balanced assessment of the NGF's evolving role in Nigeria's system of governance.

The NGF, Democratic Consolidation, and Governance Outcomes

Beyond its institutional evolution, the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) has had tangible implications for governance and democratic development in Nigeria's Fourth Republic. As a collective platform of state executives, the Forum occupies a strategic position in shaping how federalism functions in practice. Its activities influence policy coordination, centre–state relations, and the conduct of political elites, producing outcomes that are directly relevant to debates on democratic consolidation and governance performance (Ojo, 2022; Ibeanu & Egwu, 2021).

The NGF has facilitated cooperation among states in ways that strengthen administrative capacity and policy alignment. Through regular meetings and joint initiatives, the Forum provides governors with a space to exchange experiences and coordinate responses to shared challenges, particularly in fiscal management, healthcare delivery, and education reform. Programs such as the State Peer Review Mechanism (SPRM), alongside partnerships with development actors including the World Bank and the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation, have encouraged performance benchmarking and the diffusion of policy innovations across states (NGF Secretariat, 2023). These mechanisms institutionalise peer learning and cooperative federalism, demonstrating how informal institutions can enhance governance even in the absence of formal constitutional mandates.

At the same time, the NGF's political significance produces outcomes that complicate its contribution to democratic consolidation. Episodes such as the 2013 leadership crisis, disputes over local government autonomy in 2019, and more recent controversies surrounding intra-party conflicts illustrate how partisan considerations shape the Forum's actions (Omotola, 2014; Premium Times, 2025). In these instances, the NGF functioned less as a neutral coordinating body and more as a site of political bargaining, reflecting the interplay between elite interests and institutional informality emphasised in delegative democracy theory (O'Donnell, 1994).

The Forum's informal status and absence of clear constitutional boundaries enable flexibility but also expose it to elite manipulation. Collective positions are often influenced by political

alignment and strategic calculation rather than consistent institutional rules, limiting the NGF's capacity to act as an impartial mediator in intergovernmental relations (Suberu, 2018). This dual character, cooperative yet politically contested, illustrates the broader tension between policy coordination and elite competition in hybrid democratic systems.

The 2023 removal of fuel subsidies illustrates these dynamics. President Bola Ahmed Tinubu's announcement on 29 May 2023 placed state governments at the centre of a politically sensitive reform, with expectations that the NGF would advocate mitigation measures for citizens affected by the reform. The immediate economic consequences of rising fuel prices, higher transport costs, and inflationary pressures generated public discontent and criticism from labour unions and civil society groups (Vanguard News, 2023; Ezimakor, 2023).

Despite this context, the NGF's response was restrained. Public statements largely framed the reform as fiscally necessary, with limited emphasis on social welfare or compensatory measures (Independent Newspaper Nigeria, 2023). This posture reflects structural constraints: the centralisation of fiscal authority and state dependence on federal transfers limit governors' capacity to openly challenge federal economic decisions (Afolabi, Adeboye, & Oyinloye, 2023; Nteegah, 2023). Where partisan alignment with the federal government is strong, informal institutions like the NGF are more inclined toward accommodation than negotiation (Adediji, 2025).

Compared with earlier crises, such as the 2012 subsidy reform when the NGF publicly demanded revenue-sharing adjustments and social protections, the 2023 episode highlights a narrowing of the Forum's collective advocacy. This case underscores both the potential and the limits of informal institutions: while the NGF can facilitate coordination and policy dialogue, its effectiveness as a representative and mediating body is contingent on structural incentives, partisan dynamics, and elite interests.

Thus, the NGF illustrates how informal institutions mediate the interaction between state autonomy, elite competition, and democratic consolidation. Its governance initiatives demonstrate that collective executive action can strengthen administrative capacity and policy coherence. Yet its involvement in partisan disputes and selective policy engagement reveals the structural and political limits of such coordination. This dual character provides valuable insights into how informal institutional arrangements shape governance outcomes in hybrid democracies, extending theoretical understanding of delegative democracy and elite-led federal coordination.

Institutional Significance of the NGF in Democratic Dispensation

The institutional significance of the Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) extends beyond its absence from the formal constitutional framework. Despite being an informal association, the Forum has evolved into a powerful institution shaping governance, policy direction, and elite relations within Nigeria's federal system (Helmke & Levitsky, 2004; Popoola, 2025). Its relevance underscores the influence of informal institutions in consolidating or constraining democratic practice in post-authoritarian contexts. The NGF functions as a bridge between subnational governments and the federal centre, mediating competing interests while asserting the collective autonomy of state executives.

The Forum's institutional impact is most visible in three areas: policy coordination, intergovernmental bargaining, and political mediation. First, the NGF has institutionalised peer learning and cooperative federalism through mechanisms such as the State Peer Review

Mechanism (SPRM), the Governors' Policy Coordination Framework, and thematic working groups on fiscal management and public health (NGF Secretariat, 2023). These platforms enhance administrative capacity, foster evidence-based policymaking, and facilitate collective responses to national challenges, including the COVID-19 pandemic and economic diversification initiatives.

Second, the NGF has become a central bargaining agent in intergovernmental fiscal relations. Through collective negotiation, it has influenced revenue allocation formulas, VAT administration, and the management of excess crude revenue, often tilting negotiations in favour of state governments and strengthening subnational fiscal autonomy (Ojo, 2022; Suberu, 2018). However, internal disparities in political alignment and state capacity have at times weakened its bargaining power, revealing the limits of informal institutional cohesion.

Third, the Forum plays a significant role in political mediation, acting as an informal platform for conflict resolution during constitutional debates, electoral controversies, and security crises. While this function preserves elite consensus and prevents systemic breakdowns, it also exposes the NGF to a neutrality dilemma: the tension between nonpartisan mediation and advancing the political interests of member governors (Premium Times, 2025).

The NGF exemplifies a hybrid institution, straddling formal governance structures and informal elite networks (Leftwich, 2010). Its informality affords flexibility and responsiveness but limits transparency and accountability. Decision-making is often shaped by elite consensus rather than democratic deliberation, illustrating the paradox of informal institutions: they provide stability and coordination while simultaneously reinforcing elite dominance. In the context of delegative democracy (O'Donnell, 1994), the NGF demonstrates how informal bodies mediate elite interaction, influence policy, and fill gaps left by weak formal institutions, yet remain susceptible to partisanship and executive dominance.

Policy Implications

The evolution of the NGF provides a window into the dynamics of intergovernmental relations, elite negotiation, and institutional transformation in Nigeria's democratic development. From its modest beginnings in 1999 as a consultative forum, the NGF has become a powerful informal institution, shaping national policy, intergovernmental bargaining, and the political equilibrium of the federation. Its trajectory illustrates how informal organisations can both reinforce and undermine democratic consolidation, depending on the balance between collaboration, accountability, and elite consensus.

Empirical evidence from 1999–2025 shows that while the NGF has contributed to policy innovation and subnational capacity building, it has also become a site of elite contestation and political brokerage. Interventions in fiscal and governance matters, such as revenue allocation, VAT administration, and national security, demonstrate their capacity to influence policy outcomes and assert governors' collective agency. At the same time, these same capacities can exacerbate partisanship and blur the lines between executive coordination and political advocacy (Ojo, 2022; Umoru, 2023; Premium Times, 2025).

Theoretically, the NGF exemplifies the hybrid nature of political institutions in transitional democracies. Its dual identity as a policy coordination body and a political coalition reveals the complex interplay between formal constitutional structures and informal mechanisms of power. Informal institutions like the NGF emerge to fill governance gaps left by weak formal structures but risk perpetuating elite dominance and undermining accountability (Helmke & Levitsky,

2004). In this sense, the NGF mirrors both the progress and the paradoxes of Nigeria's democratic consolidation: institutionalising intergovernmental cooperation while not fully internalising democratic norms of transparency and inclusivity.

1. To enhance the NGF's contribution to democratic development, three targeted reforms are proposed:
2. Institutional Formalisation: Develop a legislative or charter-based framework defining the NGF's roles, limits, and accountability mechanisms, reducing ambiguities that allow elite capture.
3. Transparent Decision-Making: Introduce structured procedures for resolutions and policy positions, ensuring they reflect collective governance interests rather than partisan priorities.
4. Broader Stakeholder Engagement: Systematically involve civil society organisations, policy think tanks, and subnational bureaucrats in the NGF's consultative processes to enhance legitimacy, reduce elite insularity, and strengthen democratic deliberation. These steps are essential for transforming the NGF from a politically reactive coalition into a proactive instrument of democratic consolidation and effective federalism, demonstrating how informal institutions can both complement and challenge formal governance in hybrid democracies.

Conclusion

The Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF) has, over the course of the Fourth Republic, evolved into a pivotal institution within Nigeria's federal system, simultaneously facilitating cooperation among states and shaping national political dynamics. Its trajectory from a consultative, technocratic platform to a politically influential elite bloc illustrates the dual nature of informal institutions in hybrid democracies. On one hand, the NGF has strengthened intergovernmental coordination, enhanced policy learning, and promoted governance innovations across health, education, and fiscal management. On the other hand, its involvement in partisan disputes, leadership crises, and contested policy debates underscores the risks of elite capture and the challenges of maintaining institutional neutrality.

Episodes such as the 2013 leadership dispute and the 2023 subsidy reform reveal the Forum's oscillation between assertive advocacy and political accommodation. These instances highlight the constraints imposed by centralised fiscal structures, political alignment with the federal executive, and the absence of formal constitutional backing. Yet, the Forum's enduring presence demonstrates that informal institutions can wield significant influence in shaping governance, mediating conflicts, and consolidating democratic practices even in contexts of institutional ambiguity.

Understanding the NGF's evolution provides critical insights into the dynamics of Nigerian federalism, the interplay between formal and informal institutions, and the processes of democratic consolidation in post-authoritarian contexts. As a hybrid institution, the NGF embodies both the potential for cooperative governance and the perils of elite polarisation, serving as a lens through which the strengths and vulnerabilities of Nigeria's federal experiment can be examined.

Ultimately, the NGF exemplifies how informal elite networks can complement or complicate formal governance structures. Its experience underscores the need for continued institutional innovation, greater transparency, and mechanisms to balance state autonomy with collective responsibility. By bridging the gap between formal institutions and political realities, the NGF remains a central laboratory for understanding the evolving nature of governance and democracy in Nigeria's Fourth Republic.

References

- Adebajo, T. (2023). Fuel subsidy removal and the politics of economic reform in Nigeria. Lagos: Centre for Policy Dialogue.
- Adedeji, A. O. (2025). Intergovernmental relations and coordination in Nigeria. *Kashere Journal of Politics and International Relations*, 3(4), 14–22. Retrieved from <https://journals.fukashere.edu.ng/index.php/kjpir/article/view/790>
- Adedeji, A. O. (2025). Intergovernmental relations and coordination in Nigeria. *Kashere Journal of Politics and International Relations*, 3(4), 14–22. Retrieved from <https://journals.fukashere.edu.ng/index.php/kjpir/article/view/790>
- Adegboye, S. (2017). Intergovernmental relations and the politics of the Nigeria Governors' Forum. *Nigerian Journal of Political Studies*, 13(2), 55–74. <https://doi.org/10.4314/njps.v13i2.5>
- Afolabi, O. O., Adeboye, O. T., & Oyinloye, T. Q. (2023). States' autonomy in Nigerian federalism: Delight or an aberration? *Fountain University Law Journal*, 1(1). <https://doi.org/10.53704/fulaj.v1i1.520>
- Edeh, H. (2025, March 22). Why we remain silent on Fubara's suspension – Governors' Forum. The ICIR. Retrieved from <https://www.icirnigeria.org/why-we-remain-silent-on-fubaras-suspension-governors-forum/>
- Ezimakor, T. (2023, June 1). Removing fuel subsidy now very challenging, Adamu tells APC govs. Independent Newspaper Nigeria. Retrieved from <https://independent.ng/removing-fuel-subsidy-now-very-challenging-adamu-tells-apc-govs/>
- Governors' forum: The moments that turned ugly". (2025, May 22). Within Nigeria. Retrieved from <https://www.withinnigeria.com/news/2025/05/22/2025-governors-forum-the-moments-that-turned-ugly>
- Helmke, G., & Levitsky, S. (2004). Informal institutions and comparative politics: A research agenda. *Perspectives on Politics*, 2(4), 725–740. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592704040472>
- Ibeanu, O., & Egwu, S. (2021). Democracy and the politics of federalism in Nigeria. Enugu: Fourth Dimension Publishers.
- Iledare, O. (2019). Fiscal federalism and resource politics in Nigeria. *Journal of African Political Economy*, 16(1), 43–58. <https://doi.org/10.1080/afpe.2019.0016>
- Independent Newspaper Nigeria. (2023a, July 20). Fuel subsidy: Increase in FAAC will benefit Nigeria's economy – APC govs. Retrieved from <https://independent.ng/fuel-subsidy-increase-in-faac-will-benefit-nigerias-economy-apc-govs/>
- Independent Newspaper Nigeria. (2023b, June 7). Govs back Tinubu on subsidy removal. *Vanguard News*. Retrieved from <https://www.vanguardngr.com/2023/06/govs-back-tinubu-on-subsidy-removal/>
- Leftwich, A. (2010). Beyond institutions: Leadership, power and the politics of development. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
- NGF Secretariat. (2021). The Nigeria Governors' Forum: Policy coordination and governance reform 1999–2020. Abuja: NGF Publications.
- NGF Secretariat. (2023). Annual report: Strengthening governance through intergovernmental cooperation (2022–2023). Abuja: Nigeria Governors' Forum.
- Nigeria Governors' Forum (NGF). (2013). Mission statement and charter of operations. NGF Secretariat.
- Nigeria Governors' Forum Secretariat. (n.d.). A vital stakeholder in national affairs [PDF]. Nigeria Governors' Forum. Retrieved from <https://ngf.org.ng/phocadownload/Publications/Nigeria%20Governors%20Forum%20-%20A%20vital%20stakeholder%20in%20National%20Affairs.pdf>.

- Nigeria Governors' Forum. (2020, September). The Executive Summary (Vol. 1, No. 23). Nigeria Governors' Forum Publishing. Retrieved from https://www.ngflibrary.org.ng/cgi-bin/koha/opac-detail.pl?biblionumber=19891&shelfbrowse_itemnumber=21677.
- Nteegah, A. (2023). Fiscal federalism and socioeconomic development in Nigeria. *International Journal of Multidisciplinary Research and Analysis*, 6(6). <https://doi.org/10.47191/ijmra/v6-i6-81>
- O'Donnell, G. (1996). Illusions about consolidation. *Journal of Democracy*, 7(2), 34–51. <https://doi.org/10.1353/jod.1996.0034>
- Ogunwa, S. A., & Abasilim, D. U. (2024). Democracy, federalism and governance in Nigeria. *Journal of Governance and Development*, 20(1), 105–127.
- Ojo, E. O. (2022). Intergovernmental relations and governance performance in Nigeria's Fourth Republic. *Journal of Politics and Development Studies*, 8(2), 25–41. <https://doi.org/10.5296/jpds.v8i2.18523>
- Ojo, O., & Osundina, O., & Eytayo, A. (2022). Creative and cooperative federalism: A panacea to sustaining intergovernmental relations in Nigeria. *African Renaissance*, 19(3), 211–224. https://hdl.handle.net/10520/ejc-aa_afren_v19_n3_a12
- Omotola, J. S. (2014). The politics of intergovernmental power and elite competition in Nigeria. *African Review*, 41(3), 76–94. <https://doi.org/10.1080/ar.2014.41.3.76>
- Popoola, T. (2025, March 22). Nigerian governors' forum breaks silence on Fubara's suspension. *BusinessDay*. Retrieved from <https://businessday.ng/news/article/nigerian-governors-forum-breaks-silence-on-fubaras-suspension/>
- Premium Times. (2025, March 18). Rivers crisis: NGF under fire for silence as political tensions escalate. <https://www.premiumtimesng.com/politics>
- Raleigh, C. (2023). Subnational authority and political alignment in African states. *Journal of Modern African Studies*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13510347.2023.2201495>
- Schedler, A. (1998). What is democratic consolidation? *Journal of Democracy*, 9(2), 91–107.
- Suberu, R. (2018). Federalism and democratic governance in Nigeria. Ibadan: University Press.
- Umoru, H. (2023, August 22). Brutally frank: Gobs Forum, threat to Nigeria's peace, stability, Clark. *Vanguard*. Retrieved from <https://www.vanguardngr.com/2023/08/brutally-frank-gobs-forum-threat-to-nigerias-peace-stability-clark/>
- Yusuf, T. M., & Monday, O. S. (2024). Intergovernmental conflict in Nigeria: A federalism framework for understanding causes, consequences, and solutions. *Ilomata International Journal of Social Science*, 6(3). <https://doi.org/10.61194/ijss.v6i3.1721>